

APP ECOSYSTEM



X-Men

XDA-Developers.com is a web site that was started by a handful of guys in 2003, with the sole purpose of starting a community to discuss mods and development for XDAs (PDAs with Xtra features). Eight years down the line, the site is now home to almost three million developers and end-users and is the definitive site to come to for information regarding Windows Phone and Android devices. The site sports detailed reviews of the devices, especially HTC, along with their application packages and custom ROMs for each, if available. A site that you must visit if you own a device of either platform.



Freeman, Jay

Many have moaned and groaned and cursed Apple for its “big-brother” type control of the app store. Nobody however, had the courage to stand up to it. Jay Freeman has done just that. The fact that Apple banned his app from its store didn’t stop him. He went along anyway and launched his own app store, Cydia. The app store currently provides developers and hapless iOS users alike with a “democratic” alternative to iTunes. Testament to the popularity of the app store is the fact that many of the much-hyped iOS 5 features were already implemented and available on jailbroken devices via the Cydia store.



Kindle Cloud Reader

Amazon boasts of the largest e-book store in the world, being a host to over 300,000 e-books from over 130 publishers. Amazon of course, saw no point in restricting access to only the Kindle and thus released the Kindle Cloud Reader. Not wanting to pay Apple for allowing people to use Amazon’s own services, the cloud reader was developed to be a web app capable of allowing access to its entire online library without the need for iTunes. This was a move to get away from the overbearing policies of the iTunes app store.



Ojanperä Tero (Ovi suite)

A radio engineer by profession, Ojanperä Tero was the executive VP and CTO and CSO of Nokia. He was also the man behind Nokia’s Ovi store as well as its “Comes with music” service, all of which bombed in the market. Many people do blame him for Nokia’s loss, and are, arguably, correct to some extent as he was responsible for the Symbian



Laurs, Ilja

“Appsolutely Free”, the motto of GetJar. It’s hard to believe that there’s an app store currently available that is completely



free and hosts enough apps to rival even the likes of the Android and iTunes marketplaces. Started in 2003 as a platform for developers to get access to a multitude of devices for testing, the site is now host to free apps and has served over a billion downloads so far. To Ilja Laurs, the brainchild and founder of GetJar we say, appsolutely brilliant!



Crowley, Dennis

A man featuring in Forbes’s 40 under 40 list of Business’s

hottest rising stars of 2010 must not be taken lightly, Dennis Crowley is the CEO of foursquare. foursquare is a location-based social networking website for mobile devices which allows users to “check-in” to venues. It also introduced the concept of a “Mayor” and achievement badges where the user who “checks in” earns these titles or badges. We have our very own mayoral battles going on in our office itself.



platform which is now just barely managing to even gasp for breath. However, Nokia is not giving up on him so easily, especially since he has spent 21 years of his life shaping the company into what it is today. He is now being sent off to head a Vision+, a company that will invest Nokia’s money into app development for the emerging WP7 app market.

\$33,000,000,000



is what the mobile gaming industry was worth last year. App sales have taken off at an incredible scale, outselling even online music purchases 10 to 1. OS and mobile phone manufacturers are scrambling for a share in this lucrative market, few have succeeded though. To put this in perspective, the Android marketplace rakes in a measly \$330,000,000, a tenth of Apple’s earnings.